DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 6

Cold caller and appointment setter

Profession 6 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A cold caller or appointment setter contacts prospects by phone to start conversations and book meetings for a client. The work is lawful only when it follows consent and calling rules, so compliance is part of every task.

What professionals do every day

Calls or messages a list of prospects within permitted hours, records the outcome, books meetings in the client's calendar and logs notes in the CRM.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Many businesses grow through conversations. A good appointment setter fills the sales calendar with qualified meetings and keeps the list clean.

- Calls to people who have asked not to be called.
- Poor records of who was called and when.
- Meetings booked with the wrong people.

Skills you need

- Clear phone manner and listening.
- Script adaptation.
- CRM logging.
- Knowledge of calling rules.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
HubSpot CRM	CRM and sequences	Free tier	Paid plans	www.hubspot.com
Calendly	Meeting booking	Free tier	Paid plans	calendly.com
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Write a call script with an opening, a question and a booking request.
Intermediate	Log five call outcomes in a CRM.
Advanced	Check a list against the Do Not Disturb rules before dialling.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Appointment booking for a training firm.
- **Intermediate:** Follow-up calls for a webinar.
- **Advanced:** Inbound lead calls for a clinic.

Client-ready portfolio project

A call pack for a fictional training firm: a one-page script, a call log with outcomes, and a compliance check sheet.

Worked example

Worked example. The caller asks, 'Is now a good time for two minutes?' If the answer is no, the caller books a callback time and logs it. A 'do not call' request is logged and the number is removed the same day.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Call log and compliance check

Business problem: A training firm wants calls to 200 leads. Some may have opted out.

Steps

1. Remove every number on the opt-out list and any that the rules restrict.
2. Record each call with date, time, outcome and next step.
3. Stop calling any person who asks not to be called, and log that request.
4. Report counts by outcome.

Expected output: The cleaned list, the call log and the outcome counts.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Removing opt-outs first protects the client and the callers. A log with consistent outcomes shows the true conversion rate and keeps follow-ups on time.

Common mistakes

- Dialling outside permitted hours.
- Ignoring a request to stop calling.
- Making claims about the product that are not true.
- No notes, so the next caller repeats the same questions.

Freelancing opportunities

- Appointment setting for training, real estate and service firms.
- Lead qualification calls with a CRM log.

- Briefs for 'appointment setter', 'cold calling', 'lead qualification'.

Learning resources

COMPLIANCE FIRST

Telephone marketing is regulated. Before calling, check the Do Not Disturb rules, consent and permitted calling hours in your country. For India, check the current TRAI rules and the national Do Not Disturb registry, as these change. This textbook does not give legal advice.

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- TRAI (verify current rules)
- HubSpot Academy (free courses)

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